



Leash Reactivity Reset

Reactive Walk Progress Log



FITDOG TRAINING ACADEMY

Better Leash Handling

Soft leash. Early distance.

Leash tension can make reactivity worse.

TRAINER NOTE

Stay below threshold. Distance and safety come before performance.

Start here

Dog's name

Date

Owner

Best reward

Distance first

Your dog learns when they can notice and still think.

Soft leash

Create space early. Tension raises arousal.

Mark calm

Reward looking, sniffing, and disengaging.

1 Training goal

YOUR GOAL THIS WEEK

The leash should feel like support, not tension.

2 Lesson focus checklist

- ☐ Soft leash handling
- ☐ Moving in arcs
- ☐ Handler breathing
- ☐ Creating distance early
- ☐ Avoiding head-on approaches
- ☐ Not letting the dog stare too long
- ☐ Reward placement

Supplies needed

- Front-clip harness
- High-value treats



PRACTICE · TRACK

3 Step-by-step practice plan

Walk one block focusing on a soft, J-shaped leash — mark loose leash.

When you see a trigger, create an arc — do not walk head-on.

Breathe out slowly before passing a trigger. Notice your grip.

Reward placement: treat at your side, not toward the trigger.

End the walk before leash tension becomes constant.

4 Practice tracker

Date	Location	Leash tension	Handler note	Next
Day 1	Main st.	Loose 70%	Arc past dog	Reward at hip



REVIEW · REFLECT

5 Common mistakes to avoid

AVOID THESE

- Getting too close to triggers too fast.
- Tightening the leash at triggers.
- Practicing only on hard walks.

If this happens, try this

IF THIS HAPPENS, TRY THIS

Work on cues and distance triggers.
Hard and fast: you made too close.
Leash always tight. Reward loose leash before moving again.

6 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I can explain "Better Leash Handling" clearly.
- ☐ My dog stayed under threshold most of the week.
- ☐ I ended sessions while my dog could still succeed.
- ☐ My dog notices triggers and eats at working distance.

Practice one skill from "Better Leash Handling" three times this week. Note what to simplify.

What went well?

When did my dog struggle?

Questions for my Fitdog trainer:

WELFARE / SAFETY

No forced greetings or punishment. Safety and distance support progress.